try as did directors like Chandramouli. This was also the moment when the rest of the country woke up to the brilliance of Malayalam cinema, captivated by the simple yet powerful storytelling of films like *Angamaly Diaries* (2017), *Kumbalangi Nights* (2019), *Drishyam 2*, *The Great Indian Kitchen* (2021), *Aavesham*, *Manjummel Boys* (2024) and the 2025 blockbusters *L2: Empuraan* and *Lokah Chapter 1: Chandra*.

Cinema from the south, however, was not the only enemy at the gate for Bollywood. A quieter revolution called OTT was unfolding in living rooms across India, giving viewers a buffet of choices they couldn't get enough of. Amazon Prime Video's *Inside Edge* (2017) and *Sacred Games* (2018), Netflix's first major Indian original, first blew the doors wide open. In their wake came a torrent of exceptional homegrown web series from Netflix, Prime Video, Sony LIV, and Disney+ Hotstar—*Mirzapur* (2018); *Kota Factory*, *The Family Man*, *Delhi Crime*, *Four More Shots Please!*, *Made in Heaven*, *Gullak* (2019); *Paatal Lok*, *Pan-*





Screaming Success
Sept. 23, 2024

"If there's one thread uniting these horror comedies, it is that the stories are rooted in Indian folklore and superstition. "In our culture, we have had asuras and rakshasas, tantras and mantras have been part of our religious practice," says director Aditya Sarpotdar, whose *Munjya* draws from a Maharashtrian myth. "Horror narratives based on local folklore help them penetrate."